end in despair. Mangaldas wanted to acknowledge the resilience of children, while pointing to images of children playing football among rubble, repairing musical instruments and flying kites in war-torn landscapes. Ranjan approached hope with similar caution. "I'm wary of making the ending feel as though the suffering has somehow been resolved," he says. "I want room for warmth, imagination and even moments of levity, while allowing the weight of what has happened to remain."

For the SOI, the project marks a new direction as it enters its third decade. NCPA chairman and SOI co-founder Khushroo N. Suntook says the orchestra has been considering how to move beyond established repertoire and engage more meaningfully with other artistic forms. "We thought it might be good if we could collaborate properly with other genres, and not just in some superficial way," he says. Mangaldas, who is also on the NCPA board, became a natural collaborator for them.

The production is being developed with the possibility of touring internationally, with Suntook saying the SOI has already received offers from several destinations. For Mangaldas, its purpose lies in creating a space where audiences cannot look away. "I realise that my art is not going to change the reality," she says. "But, hopefully, it will encourage, embolden and give the rest of us courage to raise our voice against atrocities that often don't face the volume of condemnation they deserve." ■

—Nikhil Sardana

To be performed at the Jamshed Bhabha Theatre, NCPA, Mumbai, on Oct. 31 and Nov. 1

THE PRODUCTION BRINGS ADITI MANGALDAS'S MOVEMENT VOCABULARY INTO DIALOGUE WITH A SYMPHONIC SCORE BY RUSHIL RANJAN





« ***CARRYING THE LEGACY*** **Zahan Kapoor, Kunal Kapoor and Shaira Kapoor of the Prithvi Theatre**

the main stage will showcase an ambitious range of premiere plays. *27 Seconds* is Motley's stage adaptation of Salman Rushdie's memoir *Knife*, co-directed by Naseeruddin Shah and Arghya Lahiri, while *Eklavya – The Wronged* is FATS TheArts' contemporised Mahabharata retelling, exploring systemic caste-based exclusion. *Ashant Prashant* is D For Drama's dark comedy on wounded masculinity and online radicalisation. *Eka Natacha Mrutyu* is Natakghar & The Box's poetic Marathi monologue about an actor confronting mortality. Akvarious Productions' ferociously funny *The Crocodile* is a tale about actors and animals, while *Phayul* is Tibet Theatre's poignant drama depicting Tibetan resistance and the loss of independence in the 1950s.

Complementing the plays, Prithvi House will also host intimate Fringe shows, NT Live screenings and workshops led by Ratna Pathak Shah, Makarand Deshpande and Kumud Mishra, alongside acoustic music sets from Louis Banks and Gino Banks, Pancham Nishad and NCPA's Symphony Orchestra of India. ■

—Deepali Dhingra

To be held from Nov. 1-16 at Prithvi Theatre, Mumbai